

# UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-IV

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

**Q1. (a) "Values are inculcated, not instructed." Explain the mechanisms through which family, society and educational institutions actually transmit values, and identify the failure mode of each. (b) Examine the proposition that the Fundamental Duties in Article 51A are an effective instrument for inculcating values in Indian citizens.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (262 words; practice model, not official): (a) Transmission works through five mechanisms, of which explicit instruction is the weakest alone. Modelling transmits by observed conduct: a child copies how a scarce resource is divided at home, and a junior copies what a senior actually does. Reinforcement transmits by what is rewarded. Identification transmits through belonging - the Second ARC notes that where office brings prestige, dismissal "means disgrace for the entire family", giving relatives an incentive to restrain the officer. Instruction transmits content. Reflective revision transmits by testing inherited standards against experience. Each has a failure mode. The family models acquisitiveness and produces nepotism. Society transmits resignation; the ARC records corruption being regarded as "inevitable" and resistance as "futile". Schools reproduce hierarchy through the hidden curriculum whatever the syllabus prints. Instruction fails when taught as recall. (b) Article 51A, inserted by the 42nd Amendment in 1976 on the Swaran Singh Committee's recommendation and extended to eleven duties by the 86th Amendment in 2002, is a genuine value instrument in one respect and a weak one in another. Its strength is declaratory and educative. It converts contested standards into a public text: 51A(b) requires citizens to cherish the ideals of the freedom struggle, 51A(e) to renounce practices derogatory to the dignity of women, and 51A(h) to develop scientific temper. Indira Gandhi's stated justification was to make people conscious of duties as they are of rights. Its weakness is enforceability. The duties are non-justiciable, carry no legal sanction, and Parliament expressly declined the Committee's proposals for a penalty and for immunity of such a penalty law from challenge.

**Q2. (a) "The current internet expansion has instilled a different set of cultural values which are often in conflict with traditional values." Discuss. (b) Compare Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana and Basava's Kayaka as frameworks for dignified welfare delivery.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (272 words; practice model, not official): (a) Internet expansion changes how identity, authority and community are formed. It can promote autonomy, scientific temper, gender voice, intercultural learning and scrutiny of oppressive customs. Young people can find support beyond restrictive local settings, and public institutions can communicate across language and distance. Conflict arises when network values of speed, visibility, individual self-expression and global consumer culture meet traditions emphasising privacy, hierarchy, family authority and local continuity. The result may be generational tension, imitation, trolling, sexualised harassment, misinformation and polarisation. Yet neither category is morally pure: tradition can preserve solidarity and wisdom but also exclusion; digital culture can liberate but also manipulate attention and commodify intimacy. The ethical response is critical adaptation, not blanket rejection or surrender. Digital literacy, consent, privacy, respectful dialogue, age-appropriate safeguards and platform accountability should filter harmful practices. (b) Both Vivekananda and Basava refuse a charity model of welfare in which the giver is superior to the receiver. Both insist on a dignity model. But they ground dignity differently. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana (seeing God in the poor) derives from Advaita non-dualism: the self in all beings is one, so serving the deprived is serving the divine. This collapses the sacred-secular distinction and elevates welfare administration from bureaucratic obligation to devotional duty. Basava's Kayakave Kailasa assigns equal spiritual worth to all honest labour regardless of caste. Dignity comes not from the giver's devotion but from the worker's own productive effort. This is a proto-egalitarian labour ethic anticipating Articles 17 and 23. Administrative convergence: both reject stigmatising paperwork, public shaming of beneficiaries and humiliating eligibility procedures. A welfare scheme designed on either framework avoids processes that degrade the recipient.

**Q3. (a) "An unexamined life is not worth living." - Socrates. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) 'Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence of the rule of law.' Examine the significance of constitutional morality for a public servant, highlighting its role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (267 words; practice model, not official): (a) The quotation makes reflective scrutiny central to a worthwhile moral life. Examination means identifying one's assumptions, asking whether reasons are consistent, inviting challenge and correcting conduct when evidence exposes bias. For a civil servant, it converts conscience from a private feeling into accountable reason-giving. A district magistrate who initially attributes school absenteeism to parental indifference should test that belief through field visits. If

transport, unsafe routes and seasonal work explain the pattern, self-examination requires policy revision rather than defensive persistence. The same discipline applies to conflicts of interest, prejudice in recruitment and habitual deference to senior orders. Introspection alone is insufficient because people can rationalise self-interest. Peer review, recorded reasons, transparency and citizen consultation provide external correction. Textually, the line should be cited as Socrates speaking in Plato's Apology 38a, since Socrates wrote nothing. (b) Constitutional morality makes a public servant accountable to constitutional values and procedures rather than to personal preference, majoritarian pressure or administrative convenience. Civil education and rule-of-law practice cultivate habits of equality, due process, restraint and reason-giving. It promotes good governance when an officer acts within authority, hears affected persons, treats comparable cases consistently, discloses relevant reasons and accepts review. For example, popular hostility cannot justify excluding a minority from a public consultation. Constitutional morality also prevents an official from invoking private conscience as a licence for unilateral action: a suspected unconstitutional direction should be challenged through recorded dissent and competent review. It therefore links ethical public service with transparent, fair and answerable administration. Its practical test is whether citizens can understand, question and seek review of how public power was exercised.

**Q4. (a) "Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have the right to do and what is right to do." - Potter Stewart. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) 'In Indian culture and value system, an equal opportunity has been provided irrespective of gender identity. The number of women in public service has been steadily increasing over the years.' Examine the gender-specific challenges faced by female public servants and suggest suitable measures to increase their efficiency in discharging their duties and maintaining high standards of probity.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (267 words; practice model, not official): (a) The quotation distinguishes legal permission from ethical justification. Rights protect a legitimate sphere of choice, but exercising a right can still be selfish, disproportionate or contrary to the responsibilities attached to public office. Ethics asks what ought to be done, not merely what sanctions can be avoided. A senior official may have formal discretion to choose among eligible project sites, yet selecting land near a relative's business violates impartiality even before a specific anti-corruption offence is proved. Similarly, an authority may legally withhold optional information but should disclose it when citizens need it to protect health or livelihood. Kant's humanity formula and the fiduciary nature of public office explain the higher standard. Ethics cannot, however, authorise officials to ignore law according to personal preference. Constitutional values, recorded reasons and review must discipline the judgment. (b) Women public servants may face unsafe field conditions, inadequate sanitation and childcare, sexual harassment, stereotyping in assignments, biased appraisal, disproportionate care burdens and exclusion from informal mentoring networks. These barriers reduce efficiency and can create pressure to rely on patronage or remain silent about misconduct. Measures include safe infrastructure and transport; functional Internal Committees with time-bound, confidential redress; childcare and gender-neutral flexible work without career penalty; transparent posting and appraisal criteria; structured mentoring; equal access to operational roles; and periodic gender audit of outcomes. Decisions on accommodation should use published eligibility, recorded reasons and review so support does not become favouritism. High probity is maintained not by demanding exceptional personal sacrifice but by designing institutions that permit impartial and documented performance. Harassment complaints require due process for both complainant and respondent.

**Q5. (a) "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." - William James. What does this quotation convey to you in the present context? (b) Distinguish irregularity, waste, fraud, abuse of discretion and corruption in the utilisation of public funds.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (277 words; practice model, not official): (a) The quotation emphasises that attitude influences perception, persistence and the range of possibilities a person is prepared to attempt. A constructive attitude does not deny difficulty; it converts setbacks into information, preserves agency and supports ethical action under pressure. A newly posted officer facing entrenched malnutrition can either treat failure as proof that change is impossible or adopt a learning orientation: consult frontline workers, revise delivery timings, track exclusions and build cooperation. The changed attitude alters behaviour and can therefore alter institutional outcomes. Socratic examination prevents optimism from becoming self-deception, while Aristotelian habituation turns the orientation into stable practice. Attitude alone cannot remove poverty, discrimination, inadequate budgets or structural incentives. Positive-thinking rhetoric becomes unjust when it blames victims for conditions beyond their control. Personal agency must be paired with institutional reform and material support. (b) These terms identify different failures and should not be used as moral synonyms. An irregularity is departure from an applicable rule or procedure; it may be inadvertent and curable. Waste is avoidable expenditure or loss, even without private enrichment. Fraud requires intentional deception, such as a fictitious invoice. Abuse of discretion occurs when entrusted choice is exercised for an irrelevant, arbitrary or unauthorised purpose. Corruption uses public power for improper private, partisan or connected advantage, often through bribery, favouritism or collusion. The classification changes the response. A coding error may need correction and training; luxury spending needs value-for-money review; forged measurement requires evidence preservation and investigation; arbitrary vendor choice needs reasons and conflict review; a kickback requires competent anti-corruption process. Categories can overlap: a collusive false bill is irregular, fraudulent, wasteful and corrupt. Fair administration should classify facts before assigning stigma.

## **Q6. Distinguish hard-threshold checks from weighted checks in ethical case analysis.**

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (143 words; practice model, not official): Hard-threshold checks determine whether an option may remain under consideration. Legality is the clearest example: expected welfare cannot authorise an unlawful act. A genuine conflict of interest is similarly near-disqualifying; the officer must disclose and recuse rather than claim personal objectivity. Weighted checks compare options that survive. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion can conflict. During triage, maximising lives saved may pull against priority to the most vulnerable. The candidate must state which factor is decisive in that context and protect the weaker factor through safeguards, review or communication. The distinction produces a disciplined sequence: identify conflicts and legality; remove impermissible choices; apply moral theories and weighted checks to lawful alternatives; choose; then answer the strongest objection. Treating every consideration as equal invites vague balancing and may imply that sufficient benefit can purchase legality. Treating every value as absolute, conversely, prevents reasoned choice.

## **Q7. Explain why integrity is described as the hardest foundational value to test at recruitment. What institutional mechanisms serve as continuous proxies?**

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (143 words; practice model, not official): Integrity is the consistency of values across situations, especially under unobserved conditions. Unlike intelligence or energy, which can be assessed through examinations and performance records, integrity is asymmetrically tested: it is nearly costless to display when observed and genuinely tested only when discretion, secrecy and personal gain converge. This makes one-time recruitment tests inadequate. A candidate may answer ethics questions correctly without possessing the disposition to act on them under real pressure. The state therefore legislates proxies: annual asset declarations, conflict-of-interest disclosures, cooling-off periods for retiring officials, random departmental inspections, vigilance clearance requirements and, increasingly, 360-degree feedback under Mission Karmayogi. These mechanisms convert an unobservable trait into partially observable behaviour. Their limitation is that they monitor symptoms rather than guarantee character. The verdict is that integrity requires both value internalisation through training and institutional containers that make departure from integrity detectable and consequential.

## **Q8. An honest Municipal Commissioner investigates a fatal mall collapse and finds poor material, unauthorised construction, inspection failures and a prima facie official-builder nexus. Colleagues press for delay, the influential builder offers a bribe, and a threatened POSH complaint is used to demand silence. Discuss the ethical issues, options and selected course of action. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (208 words; practice model, not official): The case combines loss of life, corruption, regulatory capture, child labour concerns, friendship conflict, ministerial influence, bribery, pressure from colleagues and weaponisation of a possible POSH complaint. The Commissioner owes duties to victims, lawful construction, fair investigation, colleagues, the complainant if one emerges, and his own procedural protection. He may slow or suppress the inquiry, recuse entirely, disclose and seek an independent team, or continue with institutional safeguards. Suppression is illegal and betrays victims. Total recusal may protect appearance but can abandon responsibility unless a competent substitute is secured. The best course is to preserve the site, records and electronic trails; provide relief to victims; disclose friendship with the former Commissioner; constitute a multidisciplinary inquiry; record all oral pressure and the bribe approach; and escalate through vigilance and criminal channels. Any workplace complaint must go independently to a properly constituted Internal Committee. It should neither be dismissed as retaliation without inquiry nor used to halt corruption evidence. Interim reporting lines can avoid contact while both processes continue. The Commissioner should issue reasoned directions, resist transfer or career threats through written records, and seek protection for witnesses. This preserves accountability for the deaths while demonstrating that honest official protection means due process, not immunity from a separate lawful complaint.

## **Q9. Ramesh, a State Civil Services officer in a border State, submits a confidential report on illegal migrant infiltration and forged documents. A superior orders withdrawal and threatens loss of his capital posting and promotion. Examine his options, preferred course, ethical dilemmas and relevant policy measures. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (204 words; practice model, not official): Ramesh faces conflict between lawful duty and obedience, national security and humane treatment, family needs and public interest, confidentiality and escalation, and career pressure versus integrity. Withdrawal protects his immediate posting but falsifies the record. Public leakage may trigger action but compromises intelligence, privacy and operations. Silent refusal without escalation may preserve conscience yet leave the threat untreated. He should ask for the withdrawal direction in writing, preserve the original report and supporting evidence, record a reasoned dissent, and seek review

by the competent senior authority through secure channels. The report should distinguish verified infiltration, suspected official complicity and untested inference. A multidisciplinary investigation should protect intelligence sources while testing document and financial trails. If departmental capture persists, he should use authorised vigilance, security or judicial channels rather than partisan or public disclosure. He should disclose the personal posting and promotion pressure but not allow it to determine substance. Any transfer should be challenged through recorded reasons and applicable review, while continuity of investigation is secured. Policy measures include secure border systems, document-authentication audits, staff rotation, anti-collusion controls, reasoned transfer policy and protected reporting. His answer should be firm but evidence-based: written dissent protects integrity only when followed by lawful escalation and operational follow-through.

**Q10. A public-sector executive receives documents and a video suggesting that the corporation's chairman demanded a bribe connected with a large tyre order and accelerated pending bills. What should the executive do and which ethical and legal concerns arise? Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (184 words; practice model, not official): The documents create a credible allegation, not a concluded offence. The executive should secure original metadata and copies, record chain of custody, avoid alerting persons who could destroy evidence and seek confidential legal or authorised vigilance advice. The video must be authenticated and procurement files, bill-clearing patterns, communications and decision reasons independently examined. He should disclose any personal or political conflict and resist pressure either to suppress the matter or publicly convict the chairman. If a public servant demanded or accepted an undue advantage for dishonest performance, Section 7 may apply. The payer or promisor may raise Section 8; company liability depends on Section 9's associated-person and business-benefit elements, while personal corporate officer liability under Section 10 requires consent or connivance. Section 13 should be invoked only for its surviving misappropriation or illicit-enrichment heads. Section 17A and Section 19 must be assessed at their distinct investigation and cognizance stages. The executive's duty is lawful escalation, evidence protection and institutional continuity, not private retaliation. Fair hearing and confidentiality protect both the inquiry and innocent reputations while enabling proportionate criminal, disciplinary and contractual action if proved.

**Q11. A department discovers that senior officials split hospitality benefits among family members, use private messaging for official directions and punish junior officers who seek ethics advice. Propose a complete institutional response. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (235 words; practice model, not official): The facts indicate circumvention, record avoidance, conflict risk and retaliation. Immediate steps should preserve lawfully obtainable evidence, protect affected officers, stop further benefits and separate implicated officials from relevant decisions without presuming guilt. The competent authority should identify applicable gift, conflict, information, record and disciplinary provisions. Anonymous claims require corroboration; accused persons require notice, relevant material, impartial inquiry and an opportunity to respond. System repair must go beyond punishment. The code should aggregate connected benefits and cover relatives, intermediaries and hospitality, with current notified thresholds and valuation guidance. Transaction-specific declarations, beneficial-ownership checks, recusal and independent reassignment should apply in high-risk procurement. Material official directions should use authorised record systems; oral directions should be confirmed in writing where the service framework requires. Retention and audit controls should address private messaging without disproportionate surveillance. A confidential advice function should be institutionally separated from investigation, with a clear non-retaliation rule and safe escalation. Training should use the discovered pattern as an anonymised scenario. Monitoring should track advice requests, retaliation allegations, split benefits, late disclosures and repeat vendor links. Reasoned sanctions should reflect intent, value, harm, seniority and obstruction, with appeal. Finally, publish an aggregate action-and-learning report, revise loopholes prospectively and hold leaders responsible for climate. The objective is evidence-based accountability plus a workplace in which early ethical consultation is rewarded rather than treated as disloyalty. Independent review should confirm that reforms protect both integrity and legitimate employee rights.

**Q12. Sneha chairs a hospital procurement process in which her financially stressed brother is a bidder, while management says it will support whatever decision she takes. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.**

[20 marks | 300 words]

Model answer (202 words; practice model, not official): Facts: Sneha exercises procurement influence while a close family member competes for financial benefit. Stakeholders: patients, hospital management, all bidders, her brother, Sneha and institutional credibility. Constraints: management trust does not remove the conflict; procurement must conclude on time and against defensible quality and cost criteria. Options: score all bids herself; secretly disadvantage her brother; ask him to withdraw informally; or disclose

the relationship in writing, recuse, refer evaluation to an unconflicted authority and apply pre-announced criteria. The first two options remain biased in opposite directions. Informal withdrawal solves one outcome but leaves no durable process. Decision: disclose, recuse, refer and publish or consistently apply the criteria. Conflict of interest is a hard threshold; claimed personal integrity cannot make continued participation legitimate. Steelman: recusal may reveal private family hardship and delay urgently needed supplies. Disclosure should be limited to what the competent authority needs, and an alternate evaluator should be appointed immediately. Implementation: record the relationship before final evaluation, cease all influence, preserve bid confidentiality and communicate the result uniformly. Residual risk: bidders may still perceive concealed influence or reverse discrimination. Management's compliance or audit function should review the scoring trail and require the same recusal in future tenders involving the brother.

**Q13. A big corporate house is engaged in manufacturing industrial chemicals on a large scale. It proposes to set up an additional unit. Many States rejected its proposal due to detrimental effect on the environment. But one State government acceded to the request and permitted the unit close to a city, brushing aside all opposition. The unit was set up 10 years ago and was in full swing till recently. The pollution caused by the industrial effluents was affecting the land, water and crops in the area. It was also causing serious health problems to human beings and animals. This gave rise to a series of agitations demanding the closure of the plant. In a recent agitation thousands of people took part, creating a law and order problem necessitating stern police action. Following the public outcry, the State government ordered the closure of the factory. The closure of the factory resulted in the unemployment of not only those workers who were engaged in the factory but also those who were working in the ancillary units. It also very badly affected those industries which depended on the chemicals manufactured by it. As a senior officer entrusted with the responsibility of handling this issue, how are you going to address it?**

[30 marks | 350 words]

Model answer (210 words; practice model, not official): The officer must reject the false choice between uncontrolled production and abrupt livelihood destruction. Stakeholders include polluted communities, workers and their families, ancillary firms, consumers, the company, regulators, police, animals and the local ecosystem. Rights to health, livelihood and peaceful protest compete with public order and economic continuity. Immediate action should secure drinking water and medical relief, independently sample land, water and effluent, publish non-sensitive findings, and investigate both regulatory failure and any disproportionate policing. Closure should remain effective where serious non-compliance creates continuing harm, but an expert committee should assess whether a time-bound, monitored restart after proven treatment upgrades is environmentally safe. The precautionary principle governs uncertainty; polluter-pays places cleanup, health compensation and restoration costs on the company rather than taxpayers. Workers need wage support, social-security access, retraining and temporary placement; ancillary firms need transition assistance, not immunity for the polluter. A local grievance forum should include residents, workers, technical experts and administration. Any restart must require zero-bypass monitoring, public compliance reports, escrow for remediation and automatic suspension triggers. Vellore supports sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays in environmental law, but the decision remains fact-specific. The ethical settlement therefore restores ecology and health, preserves viable livelihoods where possible, assigns costs to the wrongdoer and replaces reactive agitation with accountable regulation.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS